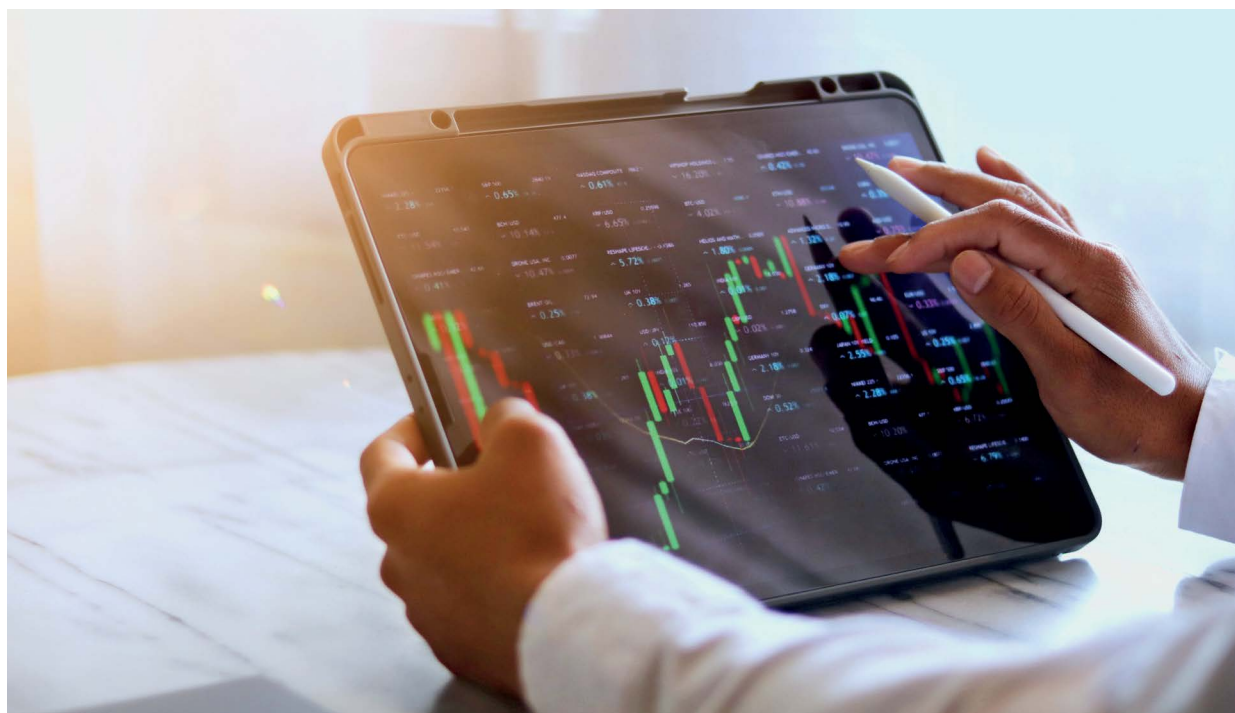


MARKET AFTERMATH

The Tide Turns

The focus of the government seems to have shifted in this Budget—from capex to boosting consumption. Markets are expected to follow suit

BY RAHUL OBEROI



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TAX BONANZA Alterations in personal taxation are poised to benefit consumer durables, quick commerce, and FMCG

► **THE CAPEX THEME** which was a favourite of Dalal Street in recent years, may take a back seat for some time as the government shifts its focus to boosting consumption amid the urban slowdown.

Market watchers believe that the tax rebate may infuse ₹1 lakh crore into the hands of middle-class households nationwide, but equity markets were not excited. After falling marginally by 0.1% during the special trading session conducted on Budget Day (February 1), the benchmark equity index NSE Nifty

50 declined by more than 0.5% to 23,361 on February 3.

Wealth manager Emkay Global Financial Services has maintained its December 2025 target for the Nifty 50 index at the 25,000-mark. Market veteran Vijay Kedia, Director, Kedia Securities, told *BTTV* that the consolidation in the stock markets may continue as the tax relief may not bring any major movement or shift.

Pawan Parakh, Fund Manager at financial services company Geojit Financial Services, says the government has tried to improve consumer

sentiment via a massive increase in the zero tax slabs.

While the key takeaway from the Budget leans towards income tax cuts and, as a result, a boost to consumption, Vipul Bhowar, Senior Director—Listed Investments at financial advisory company Waterfield Advisors, says the Budget has created opportunities for a shift in market dynamics, positioning consumption-driven sectors as likely winners. Additionally, substantial alterations in personal taxation are poised to benefit consumer